RAUSHAN ZHANDAYEVA

Quantitative and Behavioral Researcher
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SKILLS

Methods: survey instrument design and pretesting, survey experiments and A/B testing, power analysis, regression analysis, ANOVA and t-tests, supervised and unsupervised machine learning, natural language processing, web scraping, causal inference, meta-analysis, data visualization, design thinking, interviews, focus groups
Tools: R, Python, Qualtrics, SQL, Tableau, ArcGIS, LaTeX, Stata
Languages: English (fluent), Russian (fluent), Kazakh (fluent), Spanish (intermediate)

SELECTED WORK EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Associate | *Institute for Data, Democracy & Politics, GWU, Washington, D.C.* May 2026 - Present

- Built the R analysis pipeline for a three-wave newsfeed experiment (N ≈ 3,200) on algorithmic curation and climate attitudes, pooling effects via meta-analysis; co-leading the project with a team of engineers and data scientists
- Fielded, with a co-author, a 4,552-respondent survey in India pairing an 11-arm framing experiment with a conjoint (26,000+ profile evaluations) on attitudes toward Russia's war on Ukraine; estimated effects with OLS, logistic regression, and AMCEs; two co-authored manuscripts
- Programmed and pretested the Qualtrics instrument for a three-arm experiment (N ≈ 3,100) on AI-generated political ads and corrections, run with a multi-institution team; wrote the R pipeline for the LLM "digital twins" comparison
- Designing a solo, preregistered 2×2 + control survey experiment (N = 2,000 U.S. adults) testing whether disclosing a source's exposure to outside influence lowers trust in AI fact-checks more than in journalists'; fielding fall 2026
- Developing stimuli, outcome measures, and the analysis plan for a collaborative survey experiment on how misinformation and fact-checks about consumer products shift purchase intent (fielding 2026–27)

PhD Candidate | *George Washington University, Washington, D.C.* Aug 2020 - May 2026

- Delivered computational social science research projects in R and Python from design through fielding, analysis, and write-up; co-authored 4 peer-reviewed papers and 7 public facing articles; gave 20+ academic and policy presentations
- Ran survey experiments in six countries (cumulative N > 8,500) across three multi-year collaborative projects on misinformation and conflict narratives
- Modeled correlates of wartime public opinion from two-country survey data (N = 3,000+) using multinomial logistic regression and multiple imputation (MICE); co-authored article and policy memo
- Scraped 120,000+ Russian-language news articles in Python (Selenium, Beautiful Soup); tracked narrative shifts over two years with topic models in R (LDA, STM) and a Hugging Face emotion classifier in Python
- Benchmarked 12 classifiers (logit, LDA, ridge, lasso, KNN, CART, bagging, random forest, boosting, SVM) by AUC to predict anti-migrant sentiment in Russia from World Values Survey data (N = 1,810), using PCA, KNN imputation, upsampling, and 10-fold cross-validation
- Taught a self-designed undergraduate course, Politics of Information (department Best Instructor of Record award, 2025-26), and discussion sections for 350+ students across seven courses (avg. evaluation 4.7/5.0)

User Research Consultant | *Habitat for Humanity International, Various Locations* Jan 2019 - Dec 2019

- Led consumer research within a cross-functional international team on a year-long shelter innovation project; conducted on-site fieldwork in Mexico City, Mexico and Chennai, India, including 50+ interviews and focus groups with low-income households and construction market participants on housing decisions
- Translated findings into a behavior-change and design-thinking methodology, co-produced with the team and now used for training across Habitat partner offices

EDUCATION

PhD, Political Science, Comparative Politics and Research Methods | George Washington University — May 2026
MA, Political Science | George Washington University — May 2023
MA, Global Affairs | University of Notre Dame — Jun 2020
BA, Political Science and International Relations | Nazarbayev University | Astana, Kazakhstan — Jun 2018

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Deep Learning | Data Matters, UNC – Chapel Hill — Aug 2024
Data Science Professional Certificate | IBM — Jun 2024
Summer School in International Survey Methods | Vanderbilt University — Jun 2024
Summer Program in Quantitative Methods of Social Research | University of Michigan — Aug 2023